Family Interest Survey Results

What Senn families told us matters most for parent engagement programming

Collected March 12-19, 2026 | Report Card Pick-Up Activation

100+ Total Responses	**7x** Increase vs Last Year	**5+** Languages Spoken	**85%** Want to Stay Connected
85+ Email Addresses Collected	**85+** Phone Numbers Collected	**~45** Want to Get Involved	**~40** Want to Be Informed

Context

Last year, the PAC collected approximately 14 survey responses. This year, at the March 18 Report Card Pick-Up, we collected over 100 in a single afternoon. Languages represented include English, Spanish, Kinyarwanda, and Swahili. Nearly every respondent provided their email and phone number, giving the PAC a real contact list for outreach.

What Drove the Results

The single biggest driver was coordinating with teachers and administrators stationed behind the report card tables. By briefing them ahead of time and asking them to direct parents to the PAC table, we turned every report card interaction into a touchpoint. Having the survey available on the website (sennparents.com) so parents could scan and complete it on their own phones also made a significant impact. A laptop was available at the table as a backup, but most parents preferred using their own devices. The lesson: peer coordination with staff beats any single tactic.

KEY FINDING Top 3 Parent Priorities

Parents were asked to pick their top 3 topics the PAC should focus on. These results directly inform how Title I parent engagement funds should be allocated.

#1
🎓
College & Career Planning

#2
💚
Mental Health & Well-Being

#3
⚖️
Know Your Rights

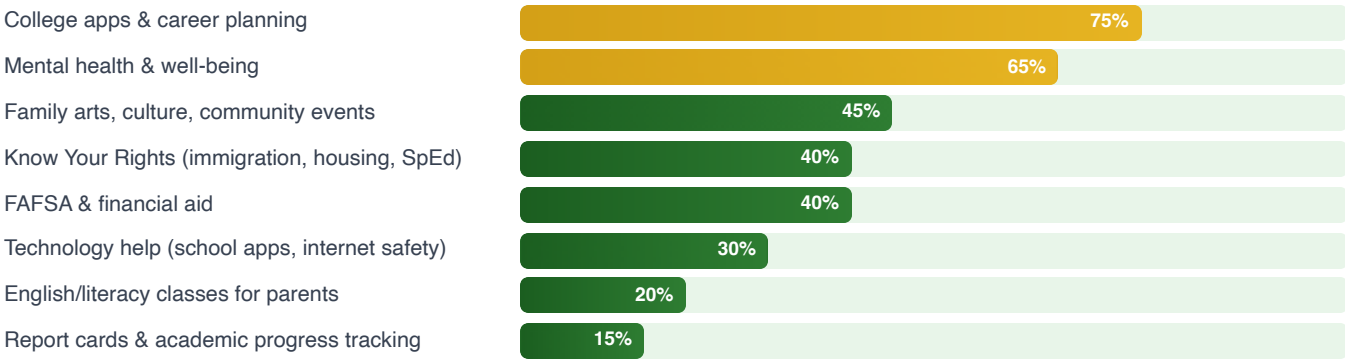
College apps, FAFSA, financial aid, career pathways

Student emotional health, warning signs, resources

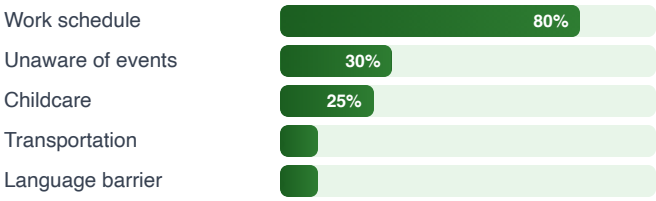
Immigration, housing, special education rights

TOPICS What Should the PAC Focus On? (Full Breakdown)

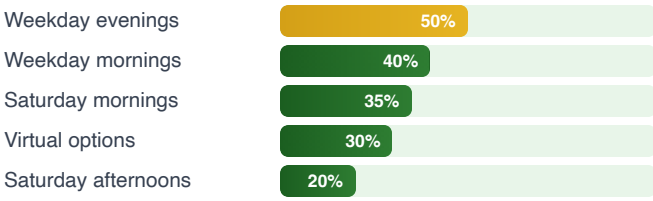
Based on 20-response sample. Percentages reflect how often each topic appeared in parent selections (each parent chose up to 3).



BARRIERS What Makes It Hard to Participate?



SCHEDULING When Can Parents Attend?



AWARENESS Had You Heard of the PAC?

Response	%
Yes	55%
No	45%

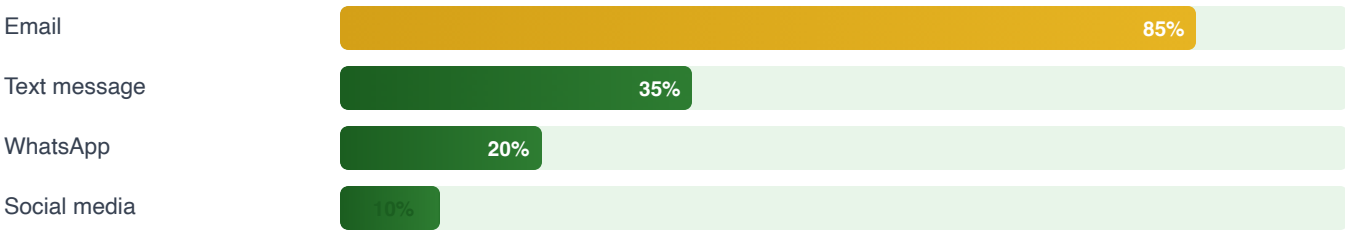
Nearly half learned about the PAC for the first time at Report Card Pick-Up.

ENGAGEMENT Want to Stay Connected?

Response	%
Yes, get involved!	45%
Keep me informed	40%
Not at this time	15%

85% of respondents want ongoing connection with the PAC.

COMMUNICATION How Parents Want to Hear From Us



Title I Funding Context

Grant #430329 (Fund 332) Title I PAC funds are NOT subject to the April 8 general spending deadline. However, with the last day of school being June 4, 2026, all parent activities and training sessions should be scheduled throughout April and May.

RECOMMENDATIONS What the Data Tells Us to Do

- **Schedule workshops in the evening.** Work schedule is the #1 barrier (80%). Weekday evenings (4-8 PM) are the most accessible time for the majority of parents.
- **Always offer a virtual option.** 30% of parents said virtual works best for their schedule. Use Zoom for hybrid access to every event.
- **Prioritize college and career planning.** This was the #1 topic chosen by 75% of respondents. FAFSA and financial aid was also ranked highly (40%), especially among 11th and 12th grade parents.
- **Address mental health.** The #2 priority at 65%. Partner with a CPS-approved wellness vendor like SEL Chicago, Wellness For Everyone, or Youth Guidance.
- **Run a Know Your Rights session.** 40% selected this, particularly families who speak languages other than English. Bilingual facilitation is essential.
- **Invest in outreach and awareness.** 45% had never heard of the PAC before this survey. 30% said "unaware of events" is a barrier. Email is the dominant channel (85%), but text and WhatsApp are important for multilingual families.
- **Build a community event.** 45% want family arts, culture, and community events. This builds trust and brings in families who might not attend a formal workshop.
- **Plan for multilingual programming.** Survey respondents speak English, Spanish, Kinyarwanda, Swahili, and other languages. Translation and culturally responsive facilitation are not optional.

NEXT STEPS Action Plan: April - June 2026

Action	Timeline	Owner
Workshop vote open on sennparents.com/vote	Now - April 20	Steve (Outreach)
Share vote results at PAC meeting	April 21	Jason (Chair)
Select and book vendor for winning workshop	Week of April 21	PAC Officers + Principal
Host first parent workshop	May (target: week of May 5)	PAC + Vendor
Plan second workshop or community event	May	PAC Officers
End-of-year PAC report and reflection	June 4 (last day)	All Officers

Vote on Our First Workshop

Parents can now vote on which workshop the PAC should organize first using Title I funds. Share this link with families and encourage them to participate before the April 21 meeting.

sennparents.com/vote

Spanish version available at sennparents.com/vota

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March 23, 2026